British Columbia on Canada's west coast for the coronation celebrations of Edward VII.[38] They brought back stories of rich fertile lands. Between 1903 and 1908, as many as 5000 Punjabi Sikhs migrated to Canada to work in lumber mills, forestry and the railroads. Racist immigration rules were soon introduced to keep out the Punjabis to protect local jobs amidst an economic downturn, including one that barred immigrants from coming to Canada unless they made a continuous journey. Gurdit Singh, a Sikh leader, decided to test this rule by hiring a Japanese ship, the *Komagata Maru*, and sailed directly from Hong Kong to Vancouver in 1914 with nearly 400 'East Indians' on board. The Canadian authorities stalled the entry of the immigrants for two months before turning the ship away by force. As many as 102 years later, the wise Canadian Prime Minister Justin Trudeau apologized for this blatant act of racial discrimination.

The restrictive laws lasted till the 1950s, by when only 3000 Indo-Canadians remained. Since then, immigration from India has gone up steadily in every decade, as did the immigration of people of Indian origin from East Africa, Guyana and Fiji. In the past two decades, immigration has been dominated by highly skilled workers under a selective points-based visa system, with greater diversity among Indian sub-groups even though Punjabis continue to be the most dominant sub-group. As a result, the state of Punjab in India continues to receive large amounts of international remittances, as it did in the 1970s when remittances helped in financing the Green Revolution.

The Punjabi link with Canada has had two fallouts. First, the turmoil in Punjab in the 1980s that was associated with Sikh militancy, the Indian Army's storming of the Golden Temple and the anti-Sikh riots after Indira Gandhi's assassination by her Sikh bodyguards led to considerable support and funding for the Khalistani separatist movement from various sections of the diaspora in Canada. It led to the tragic bombing of Air India's Flight 182 from Toronto to Delhi in 1985, over the Atlantic Ocean near Ireland, claiming over 300 lives. It still stands as one of the largest mass murders in Canadian history. Second, Punjab is famously known in India for its agricultural might but also infamously known for its 'missing women'